

The Future Drought Fund is providing funds to build the capacity and resilience of soils and agricultural landscapes to underpin farm productivity through times of drought.

The grants are for innovative NRM practices, systems and approaches. These will improve natural capital and contribute towards landscape-scale drought resilience.

In our foundational year (2020/21), following a competitive process, we awarded 66 grants. Please see the successful grants table for full details.

A competitive grants process opened in late 2021 (and closed in early 2022), following consultation on how best to target the investment to achieve the desired transformational changes in land management. This will be under the new Drought Resilient Soils and Landscapes program, which builds on both Landscapes and Grants streams of the foundational NRM Drought Resilience program. To stay up to date, please register at the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry [subscription centre](#) to be kept informed of all FDF announcements.

Funding recipient	Project Objectives and Approach	Funding	State/ Territory
		(GST exclusive)	
Kiewa Catchment Landcare Groups Incorporated	Objective: This North East Victoria soil carbon farming demonstration project will create 3 Ha sites on three properties. Approach:	\$200,000.00	VIC
Western Landcare NSW Incorporated	Objective: Farmers in arid Australia partner with researchers and practitioners to demonstrate, learn more and share their Rangeland Rehydration journey. Approach:	\$200,000.00	NSW
Bellinger Landcare Inc	Objective: The project builds landholders capacity to deliver ecosystem services including clean water, clean air, healthy soil and the conservation of biodiversity. Approach:	\$200,000.00	NSW
The Mulloon Institute Limited		\$200,000.00	QLD

	Objective: Establish a landscape rehydration demonstration site in the Landsdowne catchment.		
	Approach:		
The University of Adelaide	Objective: This project proposes a paradigm shift in sustainable agronomic practices based on Water and Carbon Neutral Farming (WCNF).	\$199,824.46	SA
	Approach:		
Heytesbury District Landcare Network Inc.	Objective: This project will continue trials on 20 farms and extend research and innovation to 10 more farms, to establish a viable community of practice.	\$199,000.00	VIC
	Approach:		
Dryland Cotton Research Association Incorporated	Objective: This project will increase the capacity of dryland farmers to respond to drought by demonstrating novel technology using Ultra High Water (UHP) for multiple operations in the cropping cycle.	\$198,500.00	NSW
	Approach:		
North Central Catchment Management Authority	Objective: This project will support farmers in the Loddon Campaspe Irrigation District (LCIR) to undertake transformational changes in the management of irrigation water.	\$198,500.00	VIC
	Approach:		
Kangaroo Island Landscape Board	Objective: This project will partner with Kangaroo Island landholders to develop water security plans for their properties.	\$197,000.00	SA
	Approach:		
Murraylands and Riverland Landscape Board	Objective: Identify key opportunities to adopt regenerative agriculture practices that complement and enhance the low rainfall farming systems of	\$197,000.00	VIC

south eastern Australia, including where current regenerative practices have been successfully employed.

Approach:

Northern Territory of Australia – Department of Industry, Tourism and Trade	Objective: The project will identify mechanisms for improving water-use efficiency for mango orchards, in addition to demonstrating advantages of alternative low water-use crops. Approach:	\$197,000.00	NT
Sub-Tropical Dairy Programme Limited	Objective: Dairy farms to improve the resilience of their business against drought, improve groundcover, nutrient utilisation and soil health, thereby reducing the risk of sediment and nutrient loss. Approach:	\$196,763.00	QLD
Southern Farming Systems Ltd	Objective: This project will work with four farmer groups in Southern Victoria (South West and Gippsland) to pilot a new approach to enhance drought preparedness during good periods in the climatic cycle to build greater buffers for inevitable difficult periods. Approach:	\$196,302.00	VIC
Rockpool Land & Water Services Pty Ltd	Objective: Undertake a regenerative grazing trial on Tasmania's drought prone east coast native and sown pastures. Approach:	\$194,375.00	TAS
Greening Australia Ltd	Objective: Provide farmers in marginal grazing country in the Flinders districts a tool and technique for modifying soil surfaces and establishing native perennial plants on degraded ground (including saltbush and fodder species).	\$194,130.00	SA

Approach:

Watershed Landcare Group Incorporated	Objective: To achieve widespread and expert use of adaptive planned grazing (APG) in local area.	\$190,900.00	NSW
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Approach:

Stirlings to Coast Farmers Inc.	Objective: Provide an enhanced local weather forecasting and a centralised dashboard to enable farmers to make better decisions and improve their farm's resilience to a changing climate.	\$190,829.00	WA
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Approach:

Bigambul Native Title Aboriginal Corporation RNTBC	Objective: To prepare primary producers, land users, and the general community to be more drought resilient and resistant.	\$190,740.00	QLD
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Approach:

Upper Clarence Combined Landcare Incorporated	Objective: Provide an expert workshop series will develop landholder awareness-knowledge farm water management.	\$190,190.00	NSW
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Approach:

Soils for Life Trust	Objective: To identify practices that build drought resilience production systems and landscapes	\$185,800.00	SA
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Approach:

The Agricultural Bureau of South Australia Incorporated	Objective: Build skills and knowledge to identify limitations and develop innovative methods for improved farming.	\$178,000.00	SA
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Approach:

Climate Friendly Pty Ltd	Objective: Clarify the linkage between implementation of carbon farming activities and	\$176,000.00	NSW
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drought resilience of farms, in both a biophysical and financial sense.

Approach:

Geeveston Community Centre Inc	Objective: Provide viable, drought adapted, profitable, low risk landscape regeneration and resilience building for Tasmanian farmers.	\$169,996.00	TAS
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Approach:

Department of Primary Industries and Regions	Objective: Optimise management strategies so that the use of groundwater can be maximised in a sustainable manner.	\$167,659.00	SA
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Approach:

Corrigin Farm Improvement Group	Objective: Demonstrate to growers that use of soil moisture retention technology can have significant benefits.	\$158,650.00	WA
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Approach:

Fitzgerald Biosphere Group Inc	Objective 1: Increase soil health and resilience across our landscapes by encouraging farmers to experiment with new and innovative ways of maintaining continuous live groundcover on their paddocks. Objective 2: Seek out and provide ongoing support to local farmers who are interested in adopting transformative NRM practices.	\$158,005.00	WA
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Approach:

Landcare Victoria Incorporated	Objective: Collect and assess information on water resources and the projected impacts of climate change to enable landholders to develop farm water plans and make informed decisions regarding their farm water supplies and future water security.	\$148,260.00	VIC
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Approach:

\$148,200.00 VIC

Gippsland Agricultural Group	Objective: Investigate the breakthrough innovation of relay cropping, to increase production sustainably and substantially with minimal risk to both the natural resource base and agricultural business.		
	Approach:		
Tweed Shire Council	Objective: To support graziers and dairy farmers to experiment with innovative farming practices to increase preparedness and resilience for future drought.	\$146,790.00	NSW
	Approach:		
Hills and Fleurieu Landscape Board	Objective: The Resilient Hills and Fleurieu project aims to increase the resilience of farming systems.	\$139,350.00	SA
	Approach:		
M.D McLeod & J McLeod	Objective: To deliver a trial for improved water retention in soil, resulting in improved drought resilience.	\$137,529.00	QLD
	Approach:		
The Alexander Family Trust	Objective: To work with four key landholders to establish regenerative farming demonstration sites in the Rockhampton and Callide regions of central Queensland.	\$128,320.00	QLD
	Approach:		
West Midlands Group Incorporated	Objective: Demonstrate to land managers that soil groundcover is more accurately monitored and measured using satellite imagery.	\$126,520.00	WA
	Approach:		
Thomas Phillip Bannigan	Objective: The aim is to increase groundcover, thus protecting soils, in pastures and erosion-prone areas.	\$115,440.00	NSW

	Approach:			
Ovens Landcare Network Incorporated	Objective: Provide landholders in the Ovens Landcare Network with resources to plan for and manage drought conditions by increasing the understanding of how water, landscape, and vegetation interact.	\$111,000.00	VIC	
	Approach:			
Hovells Creek Landcare Group Incorporated	Objective: Provide decision-support information, training and emerging decision-support software tools for members and producers in the Hovells Creek district.	\$109,500.00	NSW	
	Approach:			
GLENRAC Inc	Objective: Increase awareness and knowledge around the values of natural capital on farms and the scope for future income streams from ecosystem services on privately managed land.	\$103,796.00	NSW	
	Approach:			
West Midlands Group Incorporated	Objective: The project will demonstrate to primary producers that soil water use and nutrient cycling can be increased through growing long season crop species and varieties in rotation with other crops.	\$95,500.00	WA	
	Approach:			
Glenelg Hopkins Catchment Management Authority	Objective: The Future Ready Regions - Drought Adaptation Engagement project will increase the drought resilience of 100 farmers and agricultural enterprises in the Glenelg-Hopkins CMA region.	\$95,000.00	SA	
	Approach:			
Lower Blackwood Land Conservation District Committee	Objective: The project will provide land managers in the Lower Blackwood catchment with the knowledge and understanding required to improve	\$90,145.00	WA	

their farm's drought resilience through increasing the biodiversity of their soil and pasture systems.

Approach:

Objective: The project will investigate a whole system stubble management approach investigating different seeding systems and their interaction with retained crop stubble to measure the impact ground cover has on soil temperature and soil moisture retention.

Mingenew - Irwin Group (Inc)

\$82,478.00 WA

Approach:

Objective: Support landholders in improving the drought resilience through experimentation of NRM practices, systems, and approaches, fostering innovation and transformational change in the management of their natural capital.

Condobolin and District Landcare Management Committ Incorporated

\$66,894.00 NSW

Approach:

Objective: A demonstration of soil moisture sensors for Gippsland's vegetable industry.

Food & Fibre Gippsland Inc.

\$64,445.00 VIC

Approach:

Objective: Increase the capacity of primary producers to adapt to drought through a transformation and whole-of system approach.

South Australian No-Tillage Farmers Association Incorporated

\$61,600.00 SA

Approach:

Objective: Research enhanced desalination technology and wastewater brine management in regional Victoria to increase viability.

Grampians Wimmera Mallee Water Corporation

\$50,000.00 VIC

Approach:

Objective: A collaboration to demonstrate that through innovative practices, serious erosion can be

E.M LAKEY & J.V PEARCE

\$50,000.00 VIC

effectively managed and leveraged into productive outcomes.

Approach:

Upper Campaspe Landcare Network Incorporated	Objective: Encourage the enhancement, establishment, and preservation of native pollinator habitat through the creation of Pollinator Corridors on private and public land.	\$50,000.00	VIC
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Approach:

The University of Melbourne	Objective: To investigate a novel approach for tree selection for future climates.	\$50,000.00	VIC
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Approach:

Shire of Kojonup	Objective: Local farmers will increase understanding of drought resilient forage species, drought management, soil types, perennial pastures and the process of implementing a shrub forage system on-farm.	\$49,950.00	WA
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Approach:

Local Land Services	Objective: Develop a range of Small Farms Property Planning Tools to support small growers in the Sydney Basin to be economically, environmentally, and socially sustainable.	\$49,500.00	NSW
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Approach:

Riverine Plains Incorporated	Objective: The project, which will be co-ordinated by a project officer at Riverine Plains Inc, involves a farmer discussion group who will examine improved soil management at two demonstration sites.	\$49,400.00	VIC
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Approach:

Gippsland Seed Services Pty Ltd	Objective: To mitigate risk associated with droughts conditions, such as seed crop failure and predation by drought effected birdlife.	\$48,611.00	VIC
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	Approach:			
Yarra Yarra Catchment Management Group Incorporated	Objective: Deliver training and capacity building opportunities focused on improving the ecological function of soils.	\$46,285.00	WA	
	Approach:			
Resource Consulting Services Pty. Ltd.	Objective: Develop a Drought Planning Process online course based on the drought preparedness content delivered at Resource Consulting Services (RCS) in-person workshops.	\$45,100.00	QLD	
	Approach:			
Queensland Water and Land Carers Inc. Maleny – Scenic Rim project	Objective: This project addresses the support gaps and lack of a structured network for the growing Scenic Rim cohort in Queensland.	\$42,000.00	QLD	
	Approach:			
Australian Integrated Carbon Financial Services Pty. Ltd.	Objective: This project will provide Murray Mallee farmers practical information for establishing shelterbelts on their farms to access carbon revenue.	\$40,000.00	SA	
	Approach:			
Queensland Water and Land Carers Inc. Maleny – Moreton Bay Peri-urban project	Objective: This project addresses the support gaps and lack of a structured network for the rapidly expanding cohort in Moreton Bay, South East Queensland.	\$40,000.00	QLD	
	Approach:			
The Hathershaw Unit Trust - Classic Pastoral Company Pty Ltd	Objective: Improve current regenerative land management practices.	\$39,500.00	VIC	
	Approach:			
Macintyre AG Alliance Inc.	Objective: Project will run a two-day conference and workshop event to educate, build awareness and	\$38,855.00	QLD	

connect primary producers with the information, tools and systems that will support their capacity to prepare for and respond to future drought and climate change.

Approach:

Border Ranges – Richmond Valley Landcare Network Incorporated	Objective: The Border Ranges Richmond Valley Landcare Network (BRRVLN) will facilitate community collaboration and on-ground actions to enable a landscape-scale transition to drought resilience.	\$38,500.00	NSW
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Approach:

Tablelands Regional Council	Objective: The project will develop a novel approach to restoring tropical forest vegetation to farms and landscapes, at a scale meaningful for cost-effectively building future climate resilience.	\$36,000.00	QLD
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Approach:

Lockyer Valley Regional Council	Objective: The project will improve local graziers' knowledge and capacity to implement regenerative agriculture on their properties in the Lockyer Valley Region.	\$35,500.00	QLD
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Approach:

Samuel Peter Tregrove and Veronica Frances Tregrove	Objective: The project will improve pasture production in the non-arable hills/rangeland pasture landscape of the Mid North of South Australia, leading to reduced risk of erosion, increased water infiltration and ultimately improved production and profitability of South Australian landholders.	\$34,365.00	SA
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Approach:

Gowen Investments Pty Ltd	Objective: Experiment with species trees at a demonstration site to determine if western species are more robust in a changing climate.	\$34,300.00	NSW
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Approach:

Roth Rural & Regional Pty Ltd	Objective: To undertake on-farm experimentation at Mudgee, NSW and establish a demonstration site.	\$23,098.00	NSW
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Approach:

Anderson Horticulture Pty Ltd	Objective: To improve the capacity of horticulture to respond to future drought circumstances.	\$19,500.00	NSW
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Approach:

Funding Recipients

The 66 successful projects will:

- focus on holistic management and adopting new or existing technology and practices
- achieve benefits tailored to meet local priorities
- contribute to landscape-scale drought resilience.

Funding information

Find the details of the payment information for the NRM Drought Resilience Program – Grants program as required under Section 27A of the Future Drought Fund Act 2019 below.

Downloads

[Future Drought Fund: Natural Resource Management Drought Resilience Program - Grants \(PDF 429 KB\)](#) [Future Drought Fund: Natural Resource Management Drought Resilience Program - Grants \(DOCX 712 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Factsheets

Download

May 2021

[Future Drought Fund: Improving drought resilience of Australian agricultural lands \(PDF 231 KB\)](#)
[Future Drought Fund: Improving drought resilience of Australian agricultural lands \(DOCX 838 KB\)](#)

Future Drought Fund: Natural Resource Management (NRM) Drought Resilience Program (PDF 501 KB) Future Drought Fund: Natural Resource Management (NRM) Drought Resilience Program (DOCX 851 KB)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/drought/future-drought-fund/nrm-drought-resilience-program-grants>